

Nurse Staffing Plan Evaluation, January–June 2026

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Semiannual report of the nurse staffing committees of Tallowbrook Medical Center West and Tallowbrook Hospital Fort Bend to the Board of Directors, submitted by the System Chief Nursing Officer. This report covers the 13 pay periods from January 4 through July 4, 2026 and compares the official nurse services staffing plans with actual RN staffing.

Requirement and scope

Texas Health and Safety Code Chapter 257 requires each hospital to adopt an official nurse services staffing plan based on the needs of each patient care unit and shift. It requires a nurse staffing committee with at least 60% direct-care registered nurses that meets at least quarterly and evaluates the plan at least semiannually.

This evaluation covers the 12 inpatient units and both emergency departments. Planned hours are the staffing plan grids applied to each unit's actual census; worked hours include overtime, float pool and agency hours.

Committee activity

Both committees met in February and May 2026. Each has a direct-care RN majority selected by peers.

The committees reviewed staffing concerns raised through the concern form, the unit grids for Telemetry and 3 North, and the effect of the Central Staffing Office, which opened at Medical Center West in October 2025 and began serving Hospital Fort Bend units on February 16, 2026.

Planned versus actual staffing

Across both hospitals, 463,181 RN hours were worked against 455,155 planned, 1.8% above plan. For July to December 2025 the variance was 1.2% above plan.

Medical Center West: 1.5% above plan.

Hospital Fort Bend: 2.2% above plan.

Largest unit variances: Hospital Fort Bend emergency department (2.6%), Hospital Fort Bend ICU (2.4%) and 2 North (2.2%).

Smallest: Medical Center West Mother-Baby (0.9%) and 5 West (1.1%).

No unit worked fewer hours than planned over the period.

Premium labor and float pool

Overtime was 5.5% of worked hours, float pool 5.2% and agency 3.8%. In July to December 2025 the figures were 6.0%, 3.4% and 5.5%.

At Medical Center West, overtime was 4.9% and agency 2.8%. At Hospital Fort Bend, overtime was 6.6% and agency 5.7%; Fort Bend's agency share has fallen since it joined the Central Staffing Office but remains about twice West's.

Workforce context

Tallowbrook's hospital RN position vacancy rate was 11.8% at June 30, 2026, down from 14.9% a year earlier. For comparison, the 2024 Texas Hospital Nurse Staffing Study reported a statewide RN vacancy rate of 16.4% and a median hospital RN turnover rate of 23.2%.

Like most Texas hospitals in that study, we use shift differentials and flexible scheduling for retention.

Committee findings

The staffing plans are being met; staffing above plan is concentrated at Hospital Fort Bend and reflects higher census in January and February.

The Telemetry grid remains appropriate after review; the 3 North grid will add a charge nurse without an assignment on day shift when census exceeds 26.

Staff report that float nurses arrive with better orientation since the CSO started.

Nurse-sensitive quality indicators are reported separately in the quality report.

Recommendations to the board

Accept the staffing plans for both hospitals for July to December 2026 with the 3 North change.

Continue Central Staffing Office Phase 2, including float pool growth for Hospital Fort Bend.

Receive the next evaluation in February 2027.